

EDRM Integration for GP2 Methodological Design

(Guidance for Structuring a Traceable and Academically Defensible Research Logic)

1. Foundational Positioning (Read This First)

Before integrating EDRM anywhere in the report, the research must clearly demonstrate one governing principle:

👉 **The methodology does not originate from EDRM.**

Instead:

- field research establishes the IS situation
- desk research establishes theoretical requirements
- operationalisation translates theory into examinable elements
- Design Science governs artifact creation
- EDRM structures lifecycle conditions

This order must never be violated in the narrative.

When this hierarchy is visible, the research immediately becomes methodologically stable.

When it is not, assessors begin searching for dependency.

2. The Master Standard (Operational Form)

Your stated master standard is academically strong and should guide all writing decisions:

Every design choice must have a traceable intellectual origin supported through APA cited evidence.

Operationally, this means the reader must always be able to answer:

“Where did this decision come from?”

Acceptable origins include:

- field evidence
- theoretical constructs
- validated models
- methodological literature

Never intuition.

Never preference.

3. Correct Positioning of EDRM

EDRM must be introduced with precision.

Not as:

- a conceptual framework
- a theoretical foundation
- a methodological source

Instead, it should be positioned as:

👉 **an analytical lifecycle reference model that informed the structuring of design decisions.**

This wording accomplishes three critical things:

1. Prevents theoretical inflation
2. Protects methodological independence
3. Signals analytical maturity

The explanation should make clear that theoretical constructs defined what reproducible research requires, after which EDRM helped structure when those requirements must occur across the research lifecycle.

When written this way, EDRM strengthens the research without dominating it.

4. Provenance Must Be Strengthened Before EDRM Appears

One of the main risks you correctly identified is the perception of overreliance on EDRM.

This perception almost always emerges when provenance is underdefined.

Provenance must therefore be operationalized early.

Guidance definition:

Within this study, provenance refers to the documented lineage of datasets, analytical decisions, transformations, and interpretive steps that enables an independent actor to reconstruct how conclusions were reached.

Immediately after defining it, clarify its function:

👉 Provenance is treated as an evaluative criterion, not a conceptual ideal.

Once provenance is clearly authoritative, EDRM naturally becomes supportive rather than dominant.

5. Required Research Logic Sequence

Your structure is already strong.

This is the academically safest order:

Step 1 — Present the IS Situation

The IS must function as a diagnosis supported by evidence, not a contextual description.

Ensure the reader sees:

- observable fragmentation
- inconsistent documentation
- weak traceability
- knowledge loss across cohorts

The problem must feel evidentially heavy.

When IS is strong, theory becomes inevitable.

Step 2 — Identify Underlying Mechanisms

Before introducing theory, briefly explain what is causing the problem.

For example:

- missing lifecycle regulation
- unclear decision capture
- inconsistent artifact preservation

This prevents theory from appearing imported.

Step 3 — Introduce Theoretical Constructs

Now theory answers the mechanisms.

Each model must be justified through desk research showing its relevance to reproducibility.

The narrative should make explicit that structured desk research conducted in response to the GP1 research question led to the identification of these models.

Traceability begins here.

Step 4 — Introduce the Operationalisation Framework

Do not drop the table immediately.

First explain its purpose:

👉 to translate theoretical constructs into empirically examinable elements.

Then clarify that it guided both data collection and design reasoning.

This signals methodological control.

Step 5 — Derive the SOLL Situation

The SOLL is not a vision.

It is the structurally necessary future state required to eliminate the mechanisms identified in the IS.

When written correctly, the reader should feel the SOLL is unavoidable.

Step 6 — Present the Designed Methodology

Now explain that:

- desk research justified each stage
- operationalisation mapped methods to stages
- design decisions were intentionally selected

Use language that signals agency:

“informed by,”
“derived from,”
“guided by,”
“mapped to.”

Avoid language suggesting invention.

Step 7 — Introduce EDRM

Only now.

Position it calmly:

EDRM was used analytically to structure the lifecycle conditions under which traceable research becomes possible.

No defensiveness needed.

The hierarchy already proves independence.

6. How EDRM Should Function in the Narrative

EDRM should do one thing only:

👉 regulate **when** traceability activities occur.

Not define them.

Not justify them.

Just structure them across time.

This distinction protects methodological clarity.

7. Role of the Operationalisation Table in Design

Make the following explicit:

- constructs defined requirements
- operationalisation mapped them
- desk research justified them
- design implemented them

The reader must see a chain.

Not isolated decisions.

8. Hashing and Integrity (Careful Positioning)

Hashing must remain subordinate to provenance.

Correct framing:

- supports artifact integrity
- enables detection of undocumented changes
- strengthens traceability

Never claim prevention.

Never sound like cybersecurity.

Keep it methodological.

9. Meeting SUFFICIENT — In Absolute Totality

If everything above is followed, your research will demonstrate:

- ✓ clear problem substantiation
- ✓ traceable theoretical selection
- ✓ justified design decisions
- ✓ transparent methodology
- ✓ logical solution derivation

At this point, assessors cannot reasonably mark the work insufficient.

You have methodological completeness.

10. What Elevates This to GOOD

Add depth of reasoning.

Show explicitly:

- how field and desk research reinforce each other
- why selected models were more appropriate than alternatives
- how constructs shaped design choices

This signals analytical competence.

11. What Elevates This to EXCELLENT

Excellence is achieved when the research feels inevitable.

This occurs when:

- the causal chain is uninterrupted
- authority is correctly distributed
- lifecycle logic explains failure
- the artifact appears as the only rational response

At this level, assessors stop searching for weaknesses.

Final Strategic Guidance

Do not write defensively.

Do not argue loudly.

Instead, let the structure demonstrate control.

When each decision has a traceable intellectual origin, the research becomes self validating.

That is the essence of methodological defensibility.

One Last Recommendation (Very High Impact)

Before rewriting GP2, create a one page visual or bullet logic map for yourself:

IS → mechanisms → constructs → operationalisation → SOLL → design → lifecycle structuring.

Use it while writing.

It will prevent structural drift.

